

Wednesday, 24 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

35° 24°

BIRMINGHAM

Mostly clear

33° 20°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

31° 20°

GLASGOW

Overcast

23° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Starmer holds talks with Burnham as he seeks 'orderly' transition.

The outgoing PM is offering "access talks" with the civil service to Labour leadership candidates.

POLITICS · UK

2

Teen boy arrested on suspicion of murder after 14-year-old girl reported missing.

A body is found in the search for Lilly, 14, who was reported missing on Saturday.

UK · NEWS

3

Campaigners consider appeal after Gatwick bids fail.

A High Court ruling backs Gatwick Airport's expansion after campaigners raise climate concerns.

UK · NEWS

4

Former River City actor Iain Robertson found guilty of rape.

The 45-year-old, who played Stevie O'Hara in the BBC soap, was also convicted of assaulting two other women.

UK · NEWS

5

Nineteen injured after bus overturns in crash near roundabout.

Six people have been taken to hospital after the crash on the A484 near Kidwelly.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Ashley Cain says he's 'not proud' of sexist language.

The former BBC Three presenter says he has changed since the historical tweets were posted.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Dame Jilly Cooper leaves £8.5m fortune to children.

Dame Jilly died after sustaining a fatal head injury in a fall at her Gloucestershire home in 2025.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Ticket reseller StubHub UK customers to get refunds over illegal hidden fees.

The Competition and Markets Authority said StubHub must refund 50,000 customers and pay a fine.

SHOWBIZ · UK

4

Ransom note claims Nancy Guthrie died after abduction.

On Tuesday, Today show presenter Savannah Guthrie begged anyone with information to come forward, saying, "We are in agony."

SHOWBIZ · UK

5

Edinburgh International Festival will be phone-free - Benedetti.

The violinist, who has been festival director since 2023 says the policy has come at the request of artists and audiences.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 McCullum confused by stories of rift as Stokes returns.**
Head coach Brendon McCullum said he remains "good friends" with England captain Ben Stokes and the pair have "no idea" why rumours of a rift have emerged.
SPORT · UK
- 2 How Semenyo went from non-league to the World Cup with Ghana.**
Winger Antoine Semenyo's football journey began in the English lower leagues. BBC Sport charts his rise from Bath City to the World Cup, with Ghana poised to face England.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Have World Cup changes made final group stage games unfair?.**
With eight teams already having nothing to play for, has the jeopardy in the group stage at the World Cup been diminished? And are concerns over the integrity of competition justified?
SPORT · UK
- 4 Promotion and relegation in revamped 2028 PGA Tour.**
Promotion and relegation will be a key element of a revamped PGA Tour from 2028.
SPORT · UK
- 5 The World Cup stars being targeted by Premier League clubs.**
The World Cup stars being targeted by Premier League clubs. Who has caught the eye already, and which clubs are focusing on longer-term priorities?
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 2 Britain's appetite for 'cosy' nights in is reshaping Friday nights.**
Takeaway and streaming bookings now peak earlier in the evening, as more of us swap the big night out for a big night in.
- 3 Pub quizzes are reporting record team sign-ups, with niche rounds drawing the crowds.**
Music and picture rounds are the great levellers. The cleverest team name still wins more goodwill than the actual answers.
- 4 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 5 Cold-water taps for filling pets' bowls and watering cans are the surprise garden-centre hit.**
With more of us gardening, small convenience gadgets are booming — though the watering can remains undefeated.
- 6 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 7 More of us are batch-cooking at the weekend to dodge the weeknight scramble.**
Freezers are filling with portioned dinners. The classic mistake: forgetting to label them, then playing 'mystery soup' on a Wednesday.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims we all have one chore we secretly enjoy.**
Which household job do you actually find satisfying — and which one would you happily never do again?

- **Apparently most people have a 'lucky' item they take to big occasions.**
What's yours — and has it ever actually worked?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** A day on Venus is longer than its year — the planet spins so slowly that it takes longer to rotate once than to orbit the Sun.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A stargazing society in Devon has banned biscuits at meetings after too many telescopes were found with chocolatey fingerprints on the lenses.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Saturn would float if you could find a bathtub big enough — it's less dense than water.
- The average cloud weighs about the same as 100 elephants.
- Cats can't taste sweetness.
- The longest place name in Britain has 58 letters and is on Anglesey.
- Vending machines are statistically more dangerous than sharks.
- Humans are the only animals known to blush.
- A group of pugs is called a 'grumble'.
- The loudest natural sound ever recorded was the 1883 eruption of Krakatoa, heard thousands of miles away.

On this day

Day 175 of the year, 190 days left in 2026. Today Army Day or Battle of Carabobo Day (Venezuela); Bannockburn Day (Scotland); Christian feast day: Gohard; Christian feast day: Joseph Yuan. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Dennis Danell, American singer and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1942 — Arthur Brown, English rock singer-songwriter
- 1947 — Mick Fleetwood, English-American drummer
- 1966 — Adrienne Shelly, American actress, director, and screenwriter (died 2006)
- 1966 — Hope Sandoval, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1978 — Ariel Pink, American singer-songwriter
- 1960 — Siedah Garrett, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1988 — Micah Richards, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1948 — Cold War: Start of the Berlin Blockade: The Soviet Union makes overland travel between West Germany and West Berlin impossible.
- 2021 — The Champlain Towers South condominium in Surfside, Florida suffers a sudden partial collapse, killing 98 people inside.
- 2010 — Julia Gillard assumes office as the first female Prime Minister of Australia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1939 — Siam is renamed Thailand by Plaek Phibunsongkhram, the country's third prime minister.
- 1947 — Kenneth Arnold makes the first widely reported UFO sighting near Mount Rainier, Washington.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1994 — A Boeing B-52 Stratofortress crashes at Fairchild Air Force Base near Spokane, Washington, killing four.
- 1981 — The Humber Bridge opens to traffic, connecting Yorkshire and Lincolnshire. It remained the world's longest bridge span for 17 years.

- 2010 — At Wimbledon, John Isner of the United States defeats Nicolas Mahut of France, in the longest match in professional tennis history.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 176 of the year, 189 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Philippines); Christian feast day: David of Munktorp; Christian feast day: Dorothea of Montau; Christian feast day: Eurosia. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Ricky Gervais, English comedian, actor, director, producer and singer
- 1958 — William Basinski, American musician and composer
- 1943 — Carly Simon, American singer-songwriter
- 1925 — June Lockhart, American actress (died 2025)
- 1974 — Nisha Ganatra, Canadian director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — A. J. Quinnell, English-Maltese author (died 2005)
- 1979 — Busy Philipps, American actress
- 1940 — Mary Beth Peil, American actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2022 — Two people are killed and 21 more injured after a gunman opens fire at three sites in Oslo in a suspected Islamist anti-LGBTQ+ attack.
- 1976 — Missouri Governor Kit Bond issues an executive order rescinding the Extermination Order, formally apologizing on behalf of the state of Missouri for the suffering it had caused to members of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.
- 1993 — Kim Campbell is sworn in as the first female Prime Minister of Canada.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — American rapper Jay-Z releases his debut album, Reasonable Doubt.
- 2007 — PMTair Flight 241 crashes in the Dâmrei Mountains in Kampot Province, Cambodia, killing all 22 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)